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THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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DJIA 46124.06 ▼ 84.41 0.18% NASDAQ 21761.89 ▼ 0.8% STOXX 600 579.28 ▲ 0.4% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 14/32, yield 4.390% OIL $92.35 ▲ $4.22 GOLD $4,399.30 ▼ $4.80 EURO $1.1608 YEN 158.70

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **U.S. stock investors** showed themselves less sanguine about the prospects for a quick political deal to avert an oil shock, collectively pulling down the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow industrials by 0.4%, 0.8% and 0.2%, respectively. **B11**

◆ **A New Mexico jury** found Meta Platforms liable for failing to protect young people from online dangers, including sexually explicit content, solicitation and human trafficking. **B1**

◆ **Meta's chief technology** officer, Andrew Bosworth, is taking over supervision of the company's efforts to adopt AI across its workforce. **B4**

◆ **OpenAI plans to** discontinue the app for its Sora video platform, a product that fell from public view after a splashy release last year. **B1**

◆ **Anduril and Palantir** are part of a group developing software to operate Trump's planned Golden Dome antimissile shield. **B4**

◆ **Dollar General tapped** Ahold Delhaize veteran Jerry "JJ" Fleeman Jr. to succeed Todd Vasos as chief executive, effective Jan. 1, 2027. **B2**

◆ **Bank of Montreal plans** to launch tokenized cash services that will allow institutional clients to move funds securely at all times. **B4**

◆ **SK Hynix will spend** about $8 billion on ASML-supplied machines that print the tiny circuits on silicon wafers to boost its ability to make advanced chips. **B4**

◆ **FedEx is collaborating** with last-mile-delivery provider OneRail to offer same-day delivery service. **B3**

Worldwide

◆ **Trump said he was** confident Iran wants to "make a deal," even as frustrated U.S. allies in the Persian Gulf inched toward joining the fight as persistent attacks disrupt their economies. **A1, A6, A8**

◆ **An Israeli strike** on a naval outpost in the Caspian Sea targeted Russia's support for Iran in the war, hitting a supply line that the countries have used to move war materiel. **A8**

◆ **High prices paid** for Emirati oil that can bypass the Strait of Hormuz are a harbinger of where the rest of the market could be headed if the Gulf isn't reopened soon. **A1, A2**

◆ **Senate Republicans** offered to fund all of the Department of Homeland Security save for ICE, trying for a deal with Democrats amid a standoff. **A3**

◆ **Denmark's prime minister** led her Social Democrats to their worst election in 120 years and faces difficult negotiations to get a third term. **A10**

◆ **The NTSB said it was** investigating more than one potential problem that could have contributed to the deadly crash at LaGuardia Airport. **A3**

◆ **The Oklahoma governor** chose Alan Armstrong, an energy executive, to fill the U.S. Senate seat being vacated by Markwayne Mullin. **A3**

◆ **Police searched the** Paris offices of Edmond de Rothschild as part of a probe of a former bank worker who was an associate of Epstein. **A10**

◆ **The Taliban** released a U.S. citizen detained in Afghanistan since early 2025. **A12**

◆ **A Democrat** flipped a Florida state legislative district that includes Mar-a-Lago. **A4**

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RAJAT GUPTA/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

Indians line up to refill gas canisters in Noida on Tuesday as much of the world feels energy price shocks from the Iran war.

Oil Supply Crunch Is Spreading From Mideast to Rest of World

If strait doesn't open quickly, traders say record high prices will ripple outward

By Joe Wallace

For a glimpse of how much higher energy prices could still soar, look beyond the prices Wall Street analysts normally track for West Texas Intermediate in the U.S. and Brent in Europe.

At the center of the supply squeeze in the Middle East, traders are paying an eye-watering $160 a barrel for the Emirati oil that can dodge the Strait of Hormuz, far above those global benchmarks.

Those sky-high prices, traders said, are a harbinger of where the rest of the market could be heading if the Persian Gulf isn't reopened soon. That is because Asian customers are scouring the world for similar varieties of crude to keep churning out diesel and jet fuel.

Benchmark oil prices sank after President Trump postponed strikes on Iranian energy infrastructure and said the U.S. had held "productive" talks with Tehran, raising the prospect he might be searching for a way to end the war.

But traders warn that the talk might be another false start toward peace. They also worry that Iran must agree to an end of hostilities before oil tankers can sail freely through the strait. Unless peace talks pan out fast, record high prices for specific grades of Middle Eastern crude cargoes will soon cascade to the U.S. and elsewhere.

"The disruption is so massive, we will turn into full panic mode if this situation is not resolved rather quickly," said Helge Andre Martinsen, an energy analyst at Norwegian investment bank DNB Carnegie.

A resolution means oil flowing through the strait again. Even then, for prices to fall toward prewar levels, traders want to see Persian Gulf producers reverse output cuts from the early days of the war. It would also require long-term sanctions relief on Iran and Russia, Martinsen said. The U.S. has relaxed sanctions on both to soothe markets, but only for a month.

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◆ $5 diesel hits trucks now, economy next..... A2
◆ Houthis lie in wait on another key oil route..... A6

As U.S. Seeks an Iran Deal, Gulf Allies Get Tough

Trump says Iranians are 'talking sense'; Saudi Arabia, others weigh joining fight

By Summer Said And Jared Malsin

President Trump said Tuesday that he is confident Iran wants to "make a deal," even as frustrated U.S. allies in the Persian Gulf inched toward joining the fight as persistent attacks disrupt their economies.

Gulf leaders' recent steps support the U.S.'s ability to carry out airstrikes and open up a new line of attack on Tehran's finances. They don't yet go as far as deploying their militaries openly in the fight, a line the Gulf's rulers have hoped not to cross, though pressure is building as Iran threatens to exert greater sway over the energy-rich region.

The leaders of Gulf states, particularly United Arab Emirates and Saudi Arabia, are pressing Trump in regular phone conversations to finish the job and destroy Iran's military capabilities before moving on, Arab officials said.

Saudi Arabia recently agreed to let U.S. forces use its King Fahd air base on the western side of the Arabian Peninsula, people familiar with the decision said. The kingdom said ahead of the fighting that it wouldn't allow its facilities or airspace to be used for at-

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◆ Arms-smuggling route in Caspian Sea is hit..... A8
◆ Heard on the Street: Is U.S. debt next casualty?..... B12

INSIDE

PERSONAL JOURNAL
Looking for a magic number when it comes to how many close friends you need. **A13**

JOHN G MABANGLO/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

BUSINESS & FINANCE
Landmark verdict in New Mexico state court says Meta harmed children. **B1**

Banks Are Playing Both Sides Of the Private-Credit Turmoil

By Alexander Saeedy

JPMorgan Chase Chief Executive Jamie Dimon has long been skeptical of private credit. Lately, he has been getting a reminder why.

Blame it on the "Saaspocalypse." Private-credit managers are facing an ongoing reckoning as individual investors stampede out of private-credit funds, worried about a downturn in software, a number of high-profile defaults and restrictions on accessing their money. Managers have had to enforce limits on redemptions, with Apollo Global Management and Ares Management both seeing large withdrawal requests this week.

Dimon recently ordered a full-scale inspection of the bank's loan books for exposure to software companies. Many unprofitable software companies have borrowed risky loans from private-credit funds over the years, and earlier this year, JPMorgan told some funds that it was restricting their access to credit based on their exposure.

More recently, the bank created new strategies for hedge funds and other investor clients to bet against companies with exposure to private credit.

Since the 2008-09 financial crisis, private credit has been taking market share from the big banks, and Dimon has been among those warning about potential dangers lurking in the unregulated industry.

Now, JPMorgan and other banks are paring back risk and sensing opportunity from the weakness of private-capital firms that are simultaneously their clients and competitors.

"They're all our clients, but I'm shocked that people

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Lost a Ring In the Ocean? No Problem

* * *

Waves and sand rarely confound Zoël Manguillier

By Michael M. Phillips

TROU D'EAU DOUCE, Mauritius—Resort managers on this island paradise keep a series of phone numbers handy in case of emergency. The police, ambulance, fire department, cyclone-warning system and, of course, Zoël Manguillier, the guy to call when the groom drops his wedding ring in the Indian Ocean.

Sure, there are a few amateurs with metal detectors willing to give it a crack when a destination wedding takes a disastrous turn. But the best bet on Mauritius is Manguillier, whose record of against-all-odds ring recoveries, in sand or

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Nvidia Uses War Chest To Dominate AI Boom

Chip giant is investing billions to become the industry's top financier

Inside the gilded reception hall across San Francisco's War Memorial Opera House, some of Silicon Valley's top executives and investors in late November gathered to toast the man of the hour.

By Berber Jin, Robbie Whelan and Kate Clark

Jensen Huang, Nvidia's globe-trotting CEO, had just donated $5 million to fund a production of a new opera, "The Monkey King," based on a classic Chinese heroic novel, and invited a who's-who of the AI industry to attend a performance.

"Champagne and opera," Huang joked in a speech to more than 100 guests from OpenAI and other companies. "This is what it's like to be rich!"

The confab of Silicon Valley royalty was about more than just opera—it was about paying respect to an industry kingmaker whose company had become so flush with cash that it was bankrolling virtually everyone in the room.

Thanks to the astronomical demand for its chips prompted by the global AI boom, Nvidia generates more profit than almost any other public company on the planet. The chip giant has used its fast-growing war chest to become the industry's most powerful financier,

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